Owen Sound residential screening

Preliminary workflow demonstration: mapped planning designations, boundary checks and a documented constraint scenario.



Residential parcels (18) | Mixed-use parcels (11) | Institutional parcels (2)

Boundary review (35) | Other records (81) | Remaining scenario areas

147 total review records = 112 wholly within both mapped limits + 35 crossing records. The seven labelled records are a subset of the 18 residential-review parcels. Dark teal shows the remaining scenario pieces, not whole parcels. Solid black = city; dashed blue = settlement; grey lines = transportation context.

Projection: NAD83 / UTM 17N (EPSG:26917). Source and deduction details: pages 3-5. Parcel geometry represents municipal assessment records; this map is not a legal survey or a verified acquisition shortlist.

Seven records to review first

Map IDs correspond to the seven labelled scenario areas. Acreage is a measured screening estimate; low-density suitability remains untested.

Map ID / source FID	Location reference*	Use code	Gross ac	Scenario ac	Planning check
OS-01 FID 3558	8th St E (~243 m)	Residential development	38.16	19.66	Holding and special provisions; zoning coverage gap.
OS-02 FID 2995	8th St E (~223 m)	Residential development	20.46	15.59	Residential zones with several special provisions.
OS-03 FID 4880	Former railway corridor (~254 m)	Vacant industrial	18.60	14.75	Industrial use coding; institutional/rural zoning.
OS-04 FID 6467	Former railway corridor (~129 m)	Vacant mixed-use; partly farmed	26.32	13.42	Partly farmed; rural zoning and servicing review.
OS-05 FID 246	Former railway corridor (~217 m)	Residential development	20.86	9.97	Rural holding zone; provision 14.118.
OS-06 FID 2996	8th St E (~224 m)	Residential development	20.91	8.74	Residential/rural mix; holding and special provisions.
OS-07 FID 2100	26th St E (~150 m)	Vacant residential	24.13	8.73	Residential/industrial/commercial mix; provision 14.76.

*Location references are distances from the source-feature centroid to the nearest named feature in Official_Plan_Schedule_C. “Former Railway” is that layer’s feature name, not verified rail status. References are for orientation, not proof of legal access or frontage.

How to interpret scenario acres

Parcel ∩ city ∩ Owen Sound settlement ∩ mapped Residential designation, less the union of ten mapped review masks listed on page 3. These are scenario acres, not confirmed developable acreage. The entire Niagara Escarpment Plan boundary is currently masked; refine it using applicable designations and policies before estimating developable land. GIS outputs are required to verify the measurements.

Planning pathway remains open

No record is cleared for the client’s intended low-density form or the no-Official-Plan-Amendment requirement. Review operative designations, housing types, density, planning-area policies and site-specific exceptions. Possible zoning amendments are assessed separately; they are not automatically excluded.

A transparent screening scenario

Whole source geometries are retained. Boundary-crossing records and conditional planning pathways remain separate review queues.

Screening sequence

Audit 7,609 source features; select 5-60 gross acres and settlement-intersecting records; test city and Owen Sound settlement containment separately (outside-area tolerance: 0.01 m²); review designation, zoning and existing-use codes. Result: 147 audit records, including 35 boundary cases, 18 residential-review records, 13 conditional mixed-use/institutional records, 22 existing-use exclusions and 59 records without a five-acre scenario identified.

Deduction operation: transform working geometries to EPSG:26917, repair invalid overlays in memory, union the masks below, then subtract that union once from Residential-designation land inside both boundaries. No added buffers were used. Regulation/heritage polygons are **review masks**; their entire footprint is not a confirmed prohibition on development.

Exact layer / filter	Interpretation in this scenario
GSCA_Regulations_2025_City_Service	Regulatory review footprint; not a floodplain-only exclusion.
Ontario_Wetlands_With_Significance	Mapped wetland footprint; no assumed setback.
Ontario_Waterbodies	Mapped waterbody footprint; delineation requires checking.
County_Significant_Woodlands	County planning review polygon; not universal no-build land.
County_Significant_Valleylands	County planning review polygon; not universal no-build land.
County_Natural_Heritage_Core	Natural heritage policy review; full footprint masked.
County_Natural_Heritage_Linkage	Natural heritage policy review; full footprint masked.
Ontario_ANSI	Area of Natural and Scientific Interest; policy review.
Niagara_Escarpment_Plan_Boundary	Entire boundary masked; may remove permitted development. Refine by designation/policy before estimating developable acres.
Zoning: Layer = ZH	Mapped hazard zone; current legal boundary unverified.

Confirmed exclusions: none is certified from this overlay. Obvious-use exclusions are screening decisions, not permanent development prohibitions. Roads, occupied land, infrastructure, slopes, contamination, access and servicing have not been deducted. Largest remainder pieces do not establish usable layouts.

Railways: the Ontario_Railway_Tracks extract returned zero records and was not deducted or buffered. Schedule C shows a “Former Railway” corridor. Current status, active/abandoned rail coverage and applicable setbacks remain outstanding. **Digitized layers:** none. Missing inputs include verified current hazard limits, site-level access/servicing, building/occupation mapping and rail status.

Actual layers used (1 of 2)

Saved source snapshots: retrieved 10 October 2026. A retrieval date is not a publication or update date. No layer was digitized from a PDF.

Owen_Sound_City_Public_Parcel_Polygons | Parcel foundation (7,609 city-intersecting working features)
City of Owen Sound public CloudPermit service | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://maps.owensound.ca/server/rest/services/PLANNING/CloudPermit/MapServer/1

City_Boundary | Study limit
City of Owen Sound | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://maps.owensound.ca/server/rest/services/PUBLIC/City_Boundary/MapServer/2

County_Settlements | Owen Sound feature only: NAME=Owen Sound; MUNICIPAL=OS
Grey County | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://gis.grey.ca/server/rest/services/Public/Service_ReferenceLayersSettlements/MapServer/0

Official_Plan_Schedule_A | Planning filter: Zoning field = Residential
City of Owen Sound | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://maps.owensound.ca/server/rest/services/PUBLIC/Owen_Sound_Official_Plan/FeatureServer/77

Zoning | Zoning review; ZH mask via Layer field
City of Owen Sound | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://maps.owensound.ca/server/rest/services/PLANNING/Zoning_Owen_Sound/FeatureServer/5

Official_Plan_Schedule_C | Named road/corridor map and location context
City of Owen Sound | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://maps.owensound.ca/server/rest/services/PUBLIC/Owen_Sound_Official_Plan/FeatureServer/81

GSCA_Regulations_2025_City_Service | Review mask
GSCA via City of Owen Sound | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://maps.owensound.ca/server/rest/services/GSCAHazardLands/FeatureServer/89

Ontario_Wetlands_With_Significance | Review mask
Ontario Ministry of Natural Resources | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://ws.lioservices.lrc.gov.on.ca/arcgis2/rest/services/LIO_OPEN_DATA/LIO_Open01/MapServer/15

Ontario_Waterbodies | Review mask and map water context
Ontario Ministry of Natural Resources | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://ws.lioservices.lrc.gov.on.ca/arcgis2/rest/services/LIO_OPEN_DATA/LIO_Open01/MapServer/25

Actual layers used (2 of 2)

Saved source snapshots: retrieved 10 October 2026. A retrieval date is not a publication or update date. No layer was digitized from a PDF.

County_Significant_Woodlands | Review mask
Grey County | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://gis.grey.ca/server/rest/services/Public/Service_GCOfficialPlan/MapServer/16

County_Significant_Valleylands | Review mask
Grey County | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://gis.grey.ca/server/rest/services/Public/Service_GCOfficialPlan/MapServer/15

County_Natural_Heritage_Core | Review mask
Grey County | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://gis.grey.ca/server/rest/services/Public/Service_GCOfficialPlan/MapServer/36

County_Natural_Heritage_Linkage | Review mask
Grey County | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://gis.grey.ca/server/rest/services/Public/Service_GCOfficialPlan/MapServer/37

Ontario_ANSI | Review mask
Ontario Ministry of Natural Resources | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://ws.lioservices.lrc.gov.on.ca/arcgis2/rest/services/LIO_OPEN_DATA/LIO_Open05/MapServer/3

Niagara_Escarpment_Plan_Boundary | Review mask
Ontario / Niagara Escarpment Commission | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://ws.lioservices.lrc.gov.on.ca/arcgis2/rest/services/LIO_OPEN_DATA/LIO_Open06/MapServer/25

Ontario_Watercourses | Intersection count only; no deduction or buffer
Ontario Ministry of Natural Resources | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://ws.lioservices.lrc.gov.on.ca/arcgis2/rest/services/LIO_OPEN_DATA/LIO_Open01/MapServer/26

Ontario_Road_Network | Proximity only; no deduction or buffer
Ontario Ministry of Natural Resources | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://ws.lioservices.lrc.gov.on.ca/arcgis2/rest/services/LIO_OPEN_DATA/LIO_Open09/MapServer/0

Ontario_Railway_Tracks | Empty extract; no deduction or buffer
Ontario Ministry of Natural Resources | Retrieved 2026-10-10 | Update: Not stated in saved layer metadata
https://ws.lioservices.lrc.gov.on.ca/arcgis2/rest/services/LIO_OPEN_DATA/LIO_Open04/MapServer/18

Planning documents and approval status

Official_Plan_April_2026.pdf and Zoning_Bylaw_April_2026.pdf were retrieved October 10, 2026. The saved versions are dated April 13, 2026. Grey County reports approval of the updated plan on September 24, 2026; approved modifications, notice/appeal outcome and effective status still require reconciliation.

Planning documents: ourcity.owensound.ca/planning
Approval evidence: grey.ca/news/september-24-meeting-highlights (published September 28; checked October 13, 2026).

Data currency, commercial-use/public-display rights and legal parcel interpretation remain to be verified. Layer names containing years do not by themselves establish current regulatory status. The GIS audit, source metadata and decision tables are retained separately. This sample covers Owen Sound only.